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Part 1 – Comparative Analysis Essay

A curriculum is a plan for what teachers teach and how students learn skills step by step. It assists in informing the lessons, tests and learning objectives. The use of the K to 12 curriculum in schools took over a decade in the Philippines. Today, the Department of Education has initiated the MATATAG curriculum to ensure that the basic skills are more functional and the learning process is more effective. The essay will make a comparison of the subject of Language Arts / English in MATATAG and the previous one, the old K to 12 curriculum and how the changes will influence teaching and learning at elementary grades.

Both the K to 12 and MATATAG curricula see language as a tool for communication, learning, and identity. They both keep the four main skills in English, listening, speaking, reading, and writing. They also use a spiral approach, which means skills are repeated and improved each year. Both give importance to building literacy and exposing students to different kinds of texts, like stories and informational materials, to help them understand and express ideas better (Department of Education, 2023).

MATATAG lessens the number of skills to focus only on the most important ones. In the old K to 12, some lessons were repeated or too many for teachers to finish. In MATATAG, skills are fewer, clearer, and arranged in order that fits the age of students. Another big change is the stronger use of the student's first language (L1) in the early grades. This helps children learn sounds, word reading, and vocabulary before they fully move to Filipino and English. It also supports connecting ideas from L1 to English. The reading materials are more balanced, with stories, informational texts, and mixed media given earlier. Lastly, tests are not only paper-and-pencil exams but also real tasks that show how students use language in daily life (DepEd, 2023).

Because of these changes, teachers need to make lessons that start with the student's first language (L1) and then slowly move toward English. They should teach the four main skills together, not one by one. Teachers also need to choose local and different kinds of texts, and create activities like storytelling, projects, or group presentations instead of only written tests. This means teachers must be more thoughtful, creative, and aware of culture. For students, these changes can give them stronger reading and writing skills early, an easier shift to English, and more meaningful learning in school.

Both K to 12 and MATATAG want students to become good at using English for communication. But MATATAG makes the lessons simpler, gives more focus to learning in the first language (L1), uses a balance of text types, and highlights real-life assessments. These changes are important because they fit the real needs of students and help teachers focus on quality, not just quantity. Overall, MATATAG is a strong step toward better reading and writing skills and more useful language learning for Filipino children.

(Department of Education, 2023)